

A HEARTBREAK STORY

Unknown Strangers to Known Strangers



*A story that began on a bus, with arguments,
turned into love, then ended in heartbreak,
and is still carried by someone.*

BOOK ONE

WRITTEN BY

ARP BLOGS



Unknown Strangers to Known Strangers

A HEARTBREAK STORY
The true story of Abhi and D

BOOK ONE
by ARP Blogs

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Written and published by ARP Blogs
First Edition



for D

*For the girl who began as an argument
and became my whole world.*



*Some people walk in like an unwanted rain,
spoiling the plans you held so tight,
you curse the grey sky for the whole wet day,
then spend a lifetime, soft and afraid,
praying for that same rain to fall again.*

ARP Blogs

CHAPTER ONE

Proposing Her

2024

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WE WERE STRANGERS, ONCE. That is the part people forget when they hear how a love story begins. Before the late night calls, before the names we saved with little hearts beside them, before any of it, there were just two people who did not know the other existed. In the year 2024, I was one of those two people. And she, the girl I will simply call D in these pages, was the other.

It began, of all places, on a bus. Our Bengali coaching sir had arranged a picnic, a day trip to Jorasanko Thakurbari, the old house of Rabindranath Tagore in the heart of Kolkata. The morning felt ordinary in every way. I had no idea I was climbing onto a bus that would quietly divide my life into a *before* and an *after*.

And the *after* did not arrive gently. It arrived as a fight, a small, silly fight over a seat. I had my place, she wanted it, or perhaps it was the other way around; the truth bends a little every time I tell it. Either way, within minutes of meeting, we were arguing like two people who had disliked each other for years. Words went back and forth. Neither of us was

willing to lose. In the end we both stood up, annoyed, and went to sit far apart, on different seats, so that we would not have to see each other's face for the rest of the way.

If someone had told me, in that moment, that I would one day love this girl, I would have laughed in their face. Funny, is it not, how life saves its finest jokes for the people who are most certain they have it all figured out.



We reached Jorasanko Thakurbari by the middle of the morning. The place carries a strange quiet, old red walls, long verandahs, a hush that makes you lower your voice without knowing why. The others scattered into little groups, laughing, taking photographs. And I, I am still a little ashamed to admit this, kept finding her in the crowd.

I did not go near her. I told myself I was only wandering, only looking at the rooms where Tagore once wrote. But my eyes kept drifting to wherever she happened to be. From a distance I watched the way she laughed with her friends, the way she paused to read the old plaques on the walls. I was following her without following her, the way you keep glancing back at a song you pretend you do not like. I could not have explained it then. I am not sure I can fully explain it even now.



By the time lunch came, the morning's anger had worn thin. We all sat down together to eat, and somehow, the universe has its own sense of humour, she and I ended up facing each other. There was an awkwardness at first, the kind that lingers in the air after a quarrel. Then one of her friends, smiling, held out a toffee to me. A small thing. A silly, sweet little thing. But it cracked the ice the way the very first line breaks across a frozen pond.

We began to talk, carefully at first, then easily. Someone suggested a photo, and before I quite understood what was happening, we were leaning in for a selfie: the two strangers who, only hours earlier, could not stand the sight of each other, now smiling into the same little screen. To send each other those pictures, we exchanged phone numbers. That was all it was meant to be, a number, so that a photograph could travel from her phone to mine. I did not realise I was being handed a door.

On the way back, the bus carried a tired, happy crowd, and somewhere in that ride home the strangers had quietly turned into friends. I reached my house that evening with her number still glowing on my screen. And then I did the one thing that changed everything: I called her. Only to ask whether she had reached home safely. Only that. But she picked up, and we talked, and the call that was meant to last a minute stretched on and on, the way the best conversations always do.



After that night, talking to D became the most natural part of my day. We spoke every single day, about everything and about nothing at all. Coaching, songs, our families, our small worries, the little things we had never told anyone else. From friends we became close friends, and from close friends we became best friends, until a day without her voice began to feel like a day with something missing from it. I think I had already fallen, long before I let myself say the word.

And so it happened on the last day of the year. The thirty first of December, the night the whole world stays awake to bid one year goodbye and welcome another. That was the night I gathered every bit of courage I had and proposed to her. I told her what I had been too afraid to admit even to myself: that I loved her, that I wanted her to be mine. For one long heartbeat the world fell silent. And then she said yes, and she was so happy, so excited, that I knew at once I had not made a mistake.

Just like that, our story stepped out of the chapter of friendship and into the chapter of love. It felt sudden, and yet it felt like the most certain thing in the world, as if everything, even that foolish argument on the bus, had been gently leading us here all along.

The days that followed were the soft, golden kind. She had a coaching class near my house, and I made it my quiet little duty to pick her up and drop her every day. Those short rides became the best part of my hours, the waiting, the sight of her walking towards me, the few stolen minutes

of talk before the world pulled us back. We were in love, properly in love, the kind of love that makes ordinary streets feel like places worth remembering. We spent our time together as though there would always, always be more of it.



We did not know, back then, how carefully one must hold the things that make us happy. But that is a sorrow meant for the chapters still to come. For now, let me stay a little longer here, on that bus, in the quiet of Jorasanko, on a winter night when she said yes, back when loving her was the easiest thing I had ever done.



To be continued.

